Crafts festival from today

MADRAS, Dec. 21.

Handicrafts from the northern, central, western and southern regions will be on display and sale at a 10-day festival of crafts beginning here on Friday.

The festival has been organised by the Office of the Development Commissioner for Handicrafts (southern region), in association with the Tamil Nadu Handicrafts Development Corporation and the Crafts Council of India. Mr. C. Ramachandran, Chairman, Tamil Nadu Handicrafts Development Corporation, and Mr. K. K. Sirangi, Deputy Director, Office of the Development Commissioner for Handicrafts, said there would be no mark-up on the prices of the products.

The exhibition, to be held at the Geetha Bhavan, Avvai Shanmugam Salai (Gopalapuram), would be inaugurated by the Minister for Social Welfare and Rural Industries, Mrs. Subbulakshmi Jagadeesan.

Mr. Karpurasundarapandian, Managing Director, Tamil Nadu Handicrafts Development Corporation, said it would be making its maiden attempt at direct exports in the coming year. It hoped to sell items worth Rs. 10 lakhs (wood carvings to West Germany and brass lamps to Singapore and Malaysia).

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